OTIS · USER GUIDE

AQS Checker

Checking the quality of advice files and recording the outcome

As an **AQS Checker** you check the quality of advice. Using the standard checklist, you review the **Advice Quality** and **File Quality** of each case, record what you find and give the case its outcome. Where something falls short, you set out what the adviser needs to do to put it right. Your work is what makes the firm's advice reviews consistent, fair and on the record.

> **Where you'll work**
> In the **OTIS portal**, on the **AQS reviews** page. Sign in with your usual work account.

Where you fit in

Case received › Tax check (if needed) › **AQS check** › Adviser puts things right › T&C Manager signs off › Case closed

Your part of the journey is the AQS check. Some cases have a Tax check before yours.

What you can do

- See the queue of cases waiting for an AQS check, and **pick one up yourself**.
- Work on cases your **AQS Team Manager** has allocated to you.
- Open the case details you need, including any Tax check already completed on the case.
- Answer the checklist section by section. Your answers are saved as you go.
- Record fail reasons, comments and File Quality fail points.
- Record **who carries each fail** – the adviser, the paraplanner or someone else.
- Write a **remedial action** for every fail point.
- Give the case its outcome, submit the check and save it as a PDF.

How a typical case works for you

1. Open the **AQS reviews** page. Cases waiting for a checker appear in two groups: **Tax review completed – awaiting allocation** first, then **New – awaiting allocation**. Each group is ordered oldest first.
2. Pick up a case. It becomes yours and moves to **Allocated to me**. Your manager may also allocate cases to you directly.
3. Work through the checklist. You can stop and come back at any time; the case then shows under **In progress**.
4. Where an answer falls short, record the reason and your comments, tick any File Quality fail points that apply, and say who carries the fail.
5. Choose the outcome: **Pass**, **Pass with issues**, **Insufficient evidence** or **Potential harm**.
6. Under **Fail points and remedial actions**, write what needs to be done to put each point right. OTIS won't let you submit until every fail point has one.
7. Select **Submit this review**. The check is then locked and moves to **Completed**.

What happens after you submit

If the case passes, it closes – nobody else needs to act. If it doesn't, the case goes to the adviser to put right, and their T&C Manager signs it off. The paraplanner is emailed a copy of your completed check.

What you'll see – and what you won't

You can see

- Cases waiting for an AQS check (a summary only, until you pick one up).
- Cases allocated to you.
- Checks you have completed.

You won't see

- Cases allocated to other checkers.
- The detail of a waiting case before you take it.
- An option to change a check after it has been submitted.

Emails you'll receive

- When your AQS Team Manager allocates a case to you, you'll get an email with a link to it.

Good to know

- Cases that have already had a Tax check are flagged **Tax reviewed** and listed first. They have usually been in OTIS longer, so please prioritise them.
- Each waiting case shows **Days in OTIS** and **Waiting for AQS**, counted in working days, plus its due date.
- Only pick up what you have capacity to finish. Once you take a case, other checkers can no longer see it.
- If you took a case by mistake or can't complete it, ask your AQS Team Manager to reallocate it. Your work so far is kept.

Need help?

If something doesn't look right – a case you expected is missing, you can't open a page, or an action is refused – speak to your team manager first. They can raise it with the OTIS administrator. When you get in touch, include the case reference and a short description of what you were trying to do.